

John Whitton

Engineering Leader — Technical Leadership — Distributed Systems — Financial Infrastructure
Architecture | Hands-On Engineering | Delivery | Organizational Scaling
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Profile

Engineering leader and principal software engineer with experience spanning hands-on engineering, distributed-systems architecture, financial infrastructure, and engineering leadership.

Over more than two decades, I have built systems directly while also leading teams, architecture, delivery, and technical partnerships across enterprise software, blockchain infrastructure, payments, stablecoins, DeFi, and distributed platforms. Over the past eighteen months, I deliberately focused more deeply on hands-on engineering in Rust, trading systems, DeFi, and distributed infrastructure, strengthening the implementation depth I bring to technical leadership roles.

I lead from close technical ownership, combining architecture, people leadership, delivery execution, and hands-on engineering to build reliable systems and strong engineering teams.

Engineering & Technical Leadership

- Led engineering teams and technically complex initiatives, including an 8-engineer Eco team and Harmony engineering growth from 6 to 20 engineers.
- Led delivery of stablecoin payment infrastructure, cross-chain settlement, routing, proving, wallet services, and Layer-2 transaction execution at Eco.
- Coordinated 50+ production network upgrades, deployed 300+ nodes, supported 600+ validators, and scaled blockchain infrastructure operations at Harmony.
- Led architecture across 100+ enterprise initiatives, managed \$3M+ planning portfolios, and founded a consulting firm generating approximately \$800K annual revenue.
- Designed and implemented Salus, a Rust/Tokio distributed trading platform; retained Ethereum topology contained 2,401,108 catalog routes, with retained Base workloads measuring 16,537 sustained and 38,462 peak route evaluations/sec.
- Designed and implemented Kanga Finance, a Solidity-based DEX spanning AMMs, liquidity, staking, incentives, yield strategies, flash loans, and protocol administration.
- Designed and implemented EAVE, a Rust/Substrate Polkadot parachain and DeFi platform spanning runtime modules, staking, liquidity, EVM compatibility, APIs, and cross-chain architecture.

Representative Engineering Work

Salus (Rust)	Designed and implemented a Rust/Tokio trading platform spanning real-time market ingestion, graph construction, affected-route selection, simulation, execution, replay, and strategy analysis. Retained Ethereum topology contained 2.4M+ catalog routes; bounded asynchronous pipelines, deterministic execution boundaries, exact arithmetic, freshness controls, and execution evidence support block-sensitive multi-chain processing.	2025–Present
Seamless (Solidity/Rust)	Solidity and Rust components for leverage tokens, auction-based rebalancing, Morpho lending integrations, CoW Protocol requests, ERC-6909 accounting, and protocol invariant analysis.	2025–2026
Eco (Solidity/TypeScript)	Stablecoin payment infrastructure, programmable money, cross-chain settlement, routing, proving, wallet services, and Layer-2 transaction execution.	2023–2025
1wallet (Solidity)	One-time-password smart contract wallet eliminating seed phrase management through cryptographic OTP authentication.	2022–2023
1ns (Go/Solidity)	ENS-style decentralized naming service for Harmony using Go and Solidity.	2022–2023
Kanga Finance (Solidity)	Designed and implemented Solidity DEX infrastructure spanning AMM pools, multi-asset liquidity, staking, protocol incentives, yield strategies, flash loans, fee conversion, and liquidity migration.	2022–2023
EAVE (Rust)	Designed and built a Rust/Substrate Polkadot parachain and DeFi platform spanning runtime modules, consensus integration, governance, staking, liquidity, EVM compatibility, APIs, and cross-chain architecture; deployed standalone testnet and parachain environments.	2020–2022
Harmony (Go/Solidity)	Layer-1 blockchain infrastructure including mainnet launch, validator onboarding, staking, SDKs, Ledger integration, APIs, and ecosystem tooling.	2019–2020
Loyyal (Go)	Enterprise blockchain, transaction-processing APIs, tokenization, mobile applications, and partner integration platforms.	2016–2018
Enterprise Integration	Service-oriented platforms integrating SAP, Salesforce, payments, ecommerce, licensing, logistics, and partner ecosystems.	1999–2016

Core Technologies

Leadership	Hiring, mentoring, team scaling, technical strategy, roadmap and delivery execution, stakeholder and partner management
Architecture	Distributed systems, platform architecture, financial infrastructure, APIs, integration boundaries, enterprise integration, technical partnerships
Languages	Rust, Solidity, Go, TypeScript, Python
Distributed Systems	Rust, Tokio, async/concurrency, streaming, bounded queues, graph processing, deterministic execution, service-oriented architecture
Data Platforms	PostgreSQL, ClickHouse (evaluation), MongoDB
Cloud & DevOps	AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD
Observability	Datadog, PagerDuty
Blockchain / Runtime	Ethereum/EVM, Base, Arbitrum, Unichain, Optimism, Polkadot, Substrate, FRAME, Harmony, Hyperledger
Business / Financial	Payments, stablecoins, settlement, SAP, Salesforce, ecommerce, licensing, logistics, partner integrations
AI Engineering	AI-assisted software engineering, architecture and documentation automation, code review, Codex, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Claude

Technical Portfolio

Selected technical evidence covering distributed-systems architecture, hands-on Rust and protocol implementation, financial infrastructure, engineering decisions, and source-backed code walkthroughs. Detailed material is available for technical review.

<https://portfolio.johnwhitton.com>

Career Experience

Principal Engineer / Founder

2018 – Present

Jincubator

- Since 2025, deliberately focused more deeply on hands-on engineering, designing and implementing Rust distributed systems, trading infrastructure, DeFi protocols, and supporting technical research.
- Designed and implemented Salus across market ingestion, graph-based evaluation, simulation, execution, replay, strategy analysis, telemetry, and deterministic evidence boundaries.
- Consulted on DeFi leverage-token infrastructure, auction-based rebalancing, lending integrations, intent execution, and protocol invariants.
- Built and contributed to blockchain and protocol systems including 1wallet, 1ns, Kanga Finance, EAVE, solver/intent infrastructure, and supporting engineering tooling.
- Applied AI-assisted engineering workflows across implementation, architecture, testing, documentation, and code review while retaining deterministic engineering and validation boundaries.

Engineering Manager / Senior Protocol Engineer

Aug 2023 – Jan 2025

Eco Inc

- Led and mentored a team of 8 engineers building stablecoin payment infrastructure, programmable money systems, routing, proving, wallet, and protocol services while maintaining close technical ownership.
- Owned delivery across cross-chain routing, settlement, and transaction execution infrastructure spanning Ethereum and Layer-2 ecosystems, including recruiting, planning, architecture, and partner coordination.

Ecosystem Architect

Aug 2019 – May 2020

Harmony Protocol

- Provided technical and ecosystem leadership for Harmony Mainnet launch, staking infrastructure, APIs, SDKs, validator tooling, and partner integrations.
- Coordinated 50+ production network upgrades, deployed 300+ nodes, supported 600+ validators, hired and mentored engineers, and helped scale engineering from 6 to 20.

Chief Technology Officer

Jul 2016 – Jun 2018

Loyyal

- As CTO, hired and led distributed engineering teams building enterprise blockchain, loyalty, transaction-processing APIs, Hyperledger, private Ethereum, mobile applications, and partner integration platforms.

Earlier Experience

Enterprise Architect / Engineering Manager / Founder — EFI, Autodesk, Global Enterprise Solutions

- Built enterprise SOA platforms spanning SAP, Salesforce, licensing, ecommerce, payments, logistics, and partner systems.
- Led architecture across 100+ enterprise initiatives, managed \$3M+ planning portfolios, and founded a consulting firm generating approximately \$800K annual revenue.

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science, University of Queensland